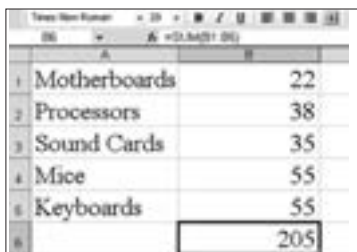




	A	B
1	Motherboards	22
2	Processors	38
3	Sound Cards	3
4	Mice	55
5	Keyboards	55
6		173

Enter a simple formula for totalling a column of values



	A	B
1	Motherboards	22
2	Processors	38
3	Sound Cards	35
4	Mice	55
5	Keyboards	55
6		205

Changes in values are reflected instantly in the total

3.3.15.2 Using Functions To Create Formulas

Rather than typing out the whole formula, there are shortcuts to creating commonly used formulas. The formula `'=B2+B3+B4+B5'` can be represented as a function: `'=SUM(B2:B5)'`. This function says that the cell is to contain the sum of the values in the cells from B2 through B5. Or, suppose you just want the sum of what is in cells B2 and B4; to add non-consecutive cells, use commas rather than a colon: `'=SUM(B2,B4,C7:C12)'` adds the values in cell B2, cell B4, and cells C7 through C12.

For common functions such as SUM, there are even shorter shortcuts. Click in cell B6 to select it, then click on the 'AutoSum' icon in the standard toolbar. Excel will assume that you wish to calculate the total of cells B2 through B5. Press [Enter] to accept Excel's assumption, and the total appears in cell B6.

The 'AutoSum' feature also works if you want to calculate the total of cells in a row. For example, to calculate the total of the values in cells B2, C2, D2, and E2 and put the total in cell F2, click in cell F2 and then click the 'AutoSum' icon. Excel will assume that you wish to calculate the total of cells B2 through E2.

Another way to create this function is to click on cell B2 and drag to cell B5 to select the column of numbers, and then click on the 'AutoSum' icon. The formula will be automatically entered, and the total will appear, in cell B6.